14.2.4 Monitor

Monitoring links real-world behavior back to governance. Every authorization decision is evidence: a data point reflecting how the system interprets policy intent. Logs, metrics, and audit trails show how often policies are evaluated, what results they generate, and whether any decision paths are unexpected. At ACME, monitoring reports support both security operations and policy reviews, closing the loop between design and application.

14.2.5 Update

No policy remains correct forever. Business priorities shift, new regulations emerge, and systems evolve. Governance determines how changes are initiated, reviewed, and approved, preventing spontaneous edits that might destabilize production. In ACME's framework, updates start with an issue or observation from monitoring, followed by a structured change proposal and another review cycle. Updates are therefore both corrective and adaptive, ensuring that the expression of institutional will remains aligned with current reality.

14.2.6 Retire

Eventually, some policies outlive their purpose. Retiring a policy is as intentional an act as creating one. Governance ensures deactivation is coordinated, dependencies are reviewed, and historical context is preserved for audits. At ACME, retired policies stay archived with metadata linking them to their successors, maintaining continuity in the organization's policy history.

The lifecycle ensures that every policy, from its creation to retirement, remains visible, explainable, and accountable. Each stage has a specific role in keeping authorization a dynamic reflection of institutional will—flexible enough to adapt to change, yet controlled enough to build trust.

At ACME, these lifecycle principles are reinforced by a suite of engineering tools—ADRs, version control, CI/CD pipelines, automated log analysis, and